



Pandemic Pains: Building A Startup In The Post-Covid World

The Covid-19 pandemic has upset the world in unimaginable ways, making the norms of business turn topsy-turvy. Now the question arises, Is it good time to take the plunge and build your own startup? Has setting up a startup changed with the advent of the 'new normal?'



Siddha Dhar

Starting a company from scratch is not as easy as it sounds. Building one in the middle of a raging pandemic could be even more difficult. But some facts appear to be quite opposite!

Indian startups bagged about \$6.5 billion in funding in the April-June 2021 quarter, while eleven of them gained unicorn status. As per a report from Nasscom-PGA Labs, 160 funding deals were closed during the second quarter—up 2% from the January-March period. This clearly proves the saying, “The brave get going when the going gets tough!”

“I don’t think there is a bad time to start. There are many successful companies that started during a financial crisis when there was virtually no funding available and the entire market economy was collapsing,” says Suresh Jayaraju, Founder and CEO, Nova Varsity.

However, there have been some subtle

and some not-so-subtle changes in market dynamics, which are expected to continue evolving as the world slowly settles down. And clearly, the process of building a startup needs to evolve too.

A robust product

There have been instances when startups set up during a market crisis ended up hitting the jackpot. An economic downturn is, however, not an assurance for the success of a startup. Though it does help in giving founders a tunnel vision where they focus solely on the quality of the product and how it can solve the customers’ problem.

Ramashish Ray, Managing Director & Chief Executive Officer, Intartic, says, “This kind of situation provides a lot of opportunities as it provides less of an entry barrier, since many of your bigger competitors are busy solving other problems.”